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CS 360: Mobile Architect & Programming

Weight Tracker

App Launch Plan

The Weight Tracker application was created to give users a simple way to keep track of their weight and view changes over time. Users can create an account, log in, add new weight entries, edit or delete old entries, and view their weight history. The app also allows users to set a goal weight and enter a phone number for SMS notifications. When the user reaches the saved goal weight, the app can send a text message if permission has been granted. The main purpose of the app is to keep weight tracking simple without adding features that make the app harder to use.

The Google Play Store description should clearly explain what the app does without making it sound more complicated than it is. The description should mention that users can record their weight, view previous entries, make changes if they entered something incorrectly, and set a personal goal weight. SMS notifications should also be mentioned because they are one of the main additional features of the app. The description should not make claims about weight loss or health because the app only tracks information entered by the user. A simple icon would fit the app better than something with a lot of detail. The current app uses different shades of blue, so the icon could use the same colors with a basic scale or progress symbol. It should still be easy to recognize when it is shown as a small app icon.

The app is set to support Android 14 and newer. The minimum SDK is API 34, which is Android 14, and the target SDK is API 36. This means the app can be used on Android 14, Android 15, and Android 16. Supporting newer Android versions makes more sense for this app because it reduces some of the problems that can happen when trying to support much older devices. The app should still be tested on more than one Android version before release. Updates to Android can change how permissions and other features work, so the app would need to continue being tested whenever the target version is updated.

The main permission used by Weight Tracker is the permission to send SMS messages. This permission is only needed if the user wants to receive a text when the goal weight is reached. It is not required for the rest of the app to work. If the user denies the permission, they can still log in, add weights, edit or delete entries, and view their history. The app does not need access to the camera, microphone, contacts, or location because none of those features are used. Only requesting the permission that is actually needed keeps the app simpler and gives the user more control over what the app can access.

Weight Tracker should be free when it is first released. The app is fairly simple, and charging for it right away could make people less likely to try it. Ads would also take up space and could make the app feel more cluttered. If more features are added later, a paid upgrade could be added instead. Some possible premium features could include progress charts, more detailed weight comparisons, data export, additional goal options, or more choices for changing the appearance of the app. A one-time upgrade would probably fit the app better than a monthly subscription because the main tracking features are basic and should remain available without requiring another recurring payment.

Before the app is released, the main functions should be tested again using an Android emulator. This should include creating an account, logging in, adding weight entries, editing and deleting them, and checking that the information is still saved after closing the app. SMS permission should also be tested both when it is allowed and when it is denied. The Play Store listing would need the finished icon, screenshots of the app, and a description of the features. The first version should stay focused on weight tracking and goal notifications. More features can be added later if they are useful without making the app harder to navigate.